

Trump has his moment

In address, he hails his ‘swift and unrelenting action’ remaking federal government



WIN MCNAMEE/POOL VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

With the vice president and the speaker behind him, President Trump spoke to Congress on Tuesday night, eight years after his first address.

Wu prepped and ready for hearing today in D.C.

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

As Boston Mayor Michelle Wu readies to testify Wednesday before the Republican-led House Oversight Committee, the city has turned to an outside law firm, Cahill Gordon & Reindel, to help her prepare, at the rate of \$950 per hour.

Hiring outside attorneys — whose tab could rise as high as \$650,000, according to city officials — is just one of many steps the mayor has taken to gear up for a hearing that is both a minefield and a potential political opportunity. Wu has also looked to

►Despite critics’ claim of lawless Boston, crime is way down. **B1.**

her colleagues in the Massachusetts congressional delegation as well as nonprofit, business, and religious leaders across the city as she readies for the high-stakes hearing.

Wu is one of four Democratic mayors set to testify before the committee, whose GOP leadership is investigating the immigration practices of Boston, Denver, Chicago, and New York in what’s expected to be a splashy, made-for-TV hearing.

Congressional hearings like this one have ended careers and soiled reputations. Look no further than the 2023 panel on campus antisemitism that led one prominent university president to resign within days and ultimately contributed to the downfall of Claudine Gay, Harvard University’s first Black female president.

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KAYLA BARTKOWSKI/GETTY IMAGES
Mayor Michelle Wu was joined by Senator Elizabeth Warren on Tuesday in Washington, D.C.

By Zeke Miller and Michelle L. Price
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Trump vowed Tuesday to keep up his campaign of “swift and unrelenting action” in reorienting the nation’s economy, immigration, and foreign policy in an unyielding address to Congress and the nation that left Democratic legislators to register their dissent with stone faces, placards calling out “lies,” and one legislator’s ejection.

Trump’s prime-time speech was the latest marker in his takeover of the nation’s capital, where the Republican-led House and Senate have done little to restrain the president as he and his allies work to slash the size of the federal government and remake the country’s place in the world.

The more than 90-minute address added up to a defiant sales

pitch for the policies that he promised during his campaign and leaned into during his first weeks back in office. Trump pledged to keep delivering sweeping changes to the country, rescuing it from what he described as destruction and mistakes left by his predecessor while repeatedly needling Democratic lawmakers who protested his remarks.

Emboldened after overcoming impeachments in his first term and criminal prosecutions in between his two administrations and with a tight grip on the Republican-controlled Congress, Trump has embarked on a mission to dismantle parts of the federal government, remake the relationship with US allies, and spark a North American trade war that is compounding economic uncertainty.

“It has been nothing but swift and unrelenting action,” Trump said

of his opening weeks in office. “The people elected me to do the job, and I am doing it.”

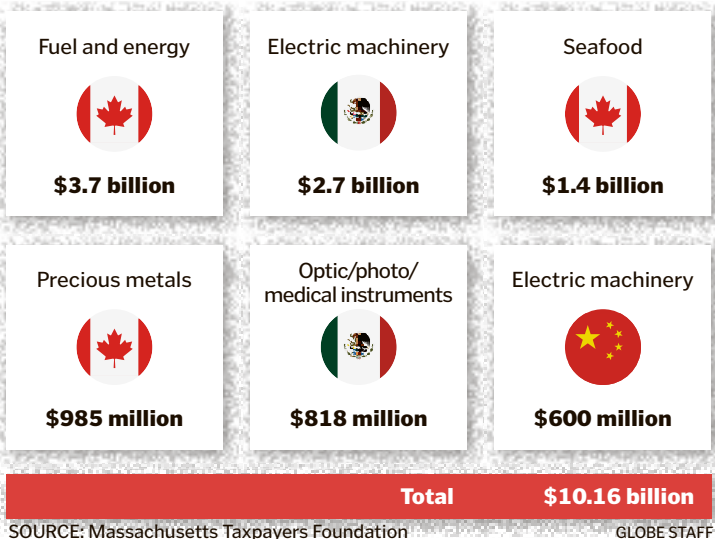
Trump, who has billionaire adviser Elon Musk orchestrating his efforts to slash the size and scope of the federal government, said he is working to “reclaim democracy from this unaccountable bureaucracy” and threatened federal workers anew with firings if they resist his agenda.

Musk, who was seated in the House gallery, received a pair of standing ovations from Republicans in the chamber, as Trump exaggerated and shared false claims about alleged government abuse uncovered by the Tesla and SpaceX founder and his team of disrupters.

Trump repeated false claims that tens of millions of dead people over 100 years old are receiving Social Security payments, prompting

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LARGEST CATEGORIES OF IMPORTS TO MASS.



GLOBE STAFF

US faces quick retaliation after launching trade war

By Josh Boak, Paul Wiseman, and Rob Gillies
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Trump launched a trade war Tuesday against the United States’ three biggest trading partners, drawing immediate retaliation from Mexico, Canada, and China and sending financial markets into a tailspin as the United States faced the threat of rekindled inflation and paralyzing uncertainty for business.

Just after midnight, Trump imposed 25 percent taxes, or tariffs, on Mexican and Canadian imports, though he limited the levy to 10 percent on Canadian energy. Trump also doubled the tariff he slapped last month on Chinese products to 20 percent.

Beijing retaliated with tariffs of up to 15 percent on a wide array of US farm exports. It also expanded the number of US companies subject to export controls and other restrictions by about two dozen.

Canadian Prime Minister Justin Trudeau said his country would plaster tariffs on more than \$100 billion of

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DEMOCRATS RESPOND

Senator Elissa Slotkin told Americans that Trump’s policies would make them pay “in every part of your life.” **A7.**



ZELENSKY OFFERS DEAL

The Ukrainian president said he is ready to release Russian prisoners of war, stop long-range strikes, and declare a truce at sea — if Russia follows suit. **A3.**

GREEN CREDITS SURVIVE

Despite Trump’s threats, federal programs to boost the sales of heat pumps and electric vehicles are still in place. **B1.**

Insurer of disabled, elderly low on cash

Commonwealth Care Alliance had been model

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

Financial turmoil has engulfed one of the largest insurers of Massachusetts’ disabled, elderly, and low-income residents, potentially challenging that vulnerable population’s access to care for complex health needs.

Should the organization fail, nearly 50,000 patients in Massachusetts could face disruptions in critical medical services.

Commonwealth Care Alliance has long been regarded as a visionary in the care of people simultaneously eligible for Medicaid, which serves mostly low-income people, and Medicare, which helps largely people over 65 and those with disabilities. Acting as both a health insurer and for some, a service provider, the nonprofit’s model is one that is deeply involved in patients’ care, often coordinating multiple specialists, appointments, and services.

But after years of multimillion-dollar operating losses, Commonwealth Care’s cash reserves have fallen dramatically, triggering MassHealth, the state’s Medicaid program, in November to block the insurer from acquiring new members. Disability advocates recently said in a letter to state regulators that they understood the company was looking to be acquired, but that those efforts have so far been unsuccessful.

Executives from Commonwealth Care declined to comment.

The organization’s financial struggles come after a period of

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Food writer Devra First checks out Somaek, a Korean restaurant from chef Jamie Bissonnette (above, dwaengi bulgogi). **G1.**

Auditor Diana DiZogio accused Attorney General Andrea Campbell of trying to “scapegoat” her office over a controversial zoning law. **B1.**

The price of eggs has risen by more than 50 percent in the Boston area since the fall, driven by the bird flu outbreak. **B5.**

Boston homeowners and residential landlords can expect property tax bills similar to the higher bills of January. **B1.**



Pour taste

Wednesday: Rain, heavy late. High 51-56. Low 48-53.

Thursday: Cloudy but warm. High 56-61. Low 28-33.

High tide: 2:48 a.m., 3:26 p.m. Sunrise: 6:13 Sunset: 5:39

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